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Publications (Link: /search/document-type/publication?xmPrimaryDocType=publication&sort=date)

ADHD Management Information (Link: /data-and-information/publications/statistical/mi-adhd)

ADHD Management Information - May 2025

Publication, Part of ADHD Management Information (Link: /data-and-information/publications/statistical/mi-adhd)

ADHD Management Information - May 2025

Publication Date:

29 May 2025

Date Range:

01 Mar 2024 to 01 May 2025

Summary

Attention deficit hyperactivity disorder (ADHD) is defined by the World Health Organization as being characterised by a persistent pattern of inattention and/or hyperactivity-impulsivity that has a direct negative impact on academic, occupational, or social functioning, the level of which is outside the limits of normal variation expected for

age and level of intellectual functioning. Historically there has been no specific data publicly available about people with ADHD. The ADHD data improvement plan highlighted the need to make use of and publish existing data held by NHS England in this area whilst also working to improve data quality.

In this initial publication data is available on the following areas: estimated prevalence of ADHD, the number of people who may be waiting for ADHD assessments, including how long they have been waiting.

A full list of measures currently contained in the publication is published in a data dictionary alongside each release

Key Facts

Estimated number of people with ADHD

In May 2025 it is estimated that 2,498,000 people in England have ADHD, including those without a diagnosis.

Of these an estimated 741,000 are children and young people (aged 5-24).

People waiting for an ADHD assessment

In March 2025, up to 549,000 people may be waiting for an ADHD assessment.

Of these, 378,000 referrals are recorded in the Mental Health Services Dataset (MHSDS) and 171,000 in the Community Health Services (CHS) SitRep dataset.

New referrals for an ADHD assessment

In March 2025 up to 20,000 people were newly referred for an ADHD assessment to mental health services.

This is an increase of 13.5% (2,000) from March 2024.

Give us your feedback on this publication

We'd love to know what you think of this publication, including how you use it, and any ideas for improvement

(Link: https://forms.office.com/Pages/ResponsePage.aspx?id=sITDN7CF9Ueylge0jXdO4wjaWM48eWZMtUrA_In9trNUMUIVVDJVRkRYTkV)

Resources

ADHD Management Information: May 2025

CSV 57 KB

(Link: https://files.digital.nhs.uk/A3/8EAC22/ADHD_May25.csv)

Data Dictionary

XLSX 37 KB

(Link: https://files.digital.nhs.uk/52/725355/Data_dictionary_v1.1.xlsx)

ADHD Management Information: MHSDS historic data

CSV 242 KB

(Link: https://files.digital.nhs.uk/80/F2C8B1/MHSDS_historic.csv)

Pre-Release Access List

PDF 110 KB

(Link: <https://files.digital.nhs.uk/68/522AB3/Pre-Release%20Access%20List.pdf>)

ARTICLE

Supporting Information

(Link: <https://digital.nhs.uk/data-and-information/publications/statistical/mi-adhd/supporting-information>)

Related Links

- [ADHD Data Improvement Plan \(Link: https://digital.nhs.uk/data-and-information/data-tools-and-services/data-services/neurodevelopmental-data-hub/adhd-data-improvement-plan\)](https://digital.nhs.uk/data-and-information/data-tools-and-services/data-services/neurodevelopmental-data-hub/adhd-data-improvement-plan)
 - [Neurodevelopmental Data Hub \(Link: https://digital.nhs.uk/data-and-information/data-tools-and-services/data-services/neurodevelopmental-data-hub?area=improving-data-quality\)](https://digital.nhs.uk/data-and-information/data-tools-and-services/data-services/neurodevelopmental-data-hub?area=improving-data-quality)
 - [Mental Health Services Data Set \(Link: https://digital.nhs.uk/data-and-information/data-collections-and-data-sets/data-sets/mental-health-services-data-set\)](https://digital.nhs.uk/data-and-information/data-collections-and-data-sets/data-sets/mental-health-services-data-set)
 - [Autism Waiting Time Statistics \(Link: https://digital.nhs.uk/data-and-information/publications/statistical/autism-statistics\)](https://digital.nhs.uk/data-and-information/publications/statistical/autism-statistics)
 - [Health and Care of People with Learning Disabilities \(Link: https://digital.nhs.uk/data-and-information/publications/statistical/health-and-care-of-people-with-learning-disabilities/experimental-statistics-2023-to-2024\)](https://digital.nhs.uk/data-and-information/publications/statistical/health-and-care-of-people-with-learning-disabilities/experimental-statistics-2023-to-2024)
 - [Community Health Services Waiting Lists \(Link: https://www.england.nhs.uk/statistics/statistical-work-areas/community-health-services-waiting-lists/\)](https://www.england.nhs.uk/statistics/statistical-work-areas/community-health-services-waiting-lists/)
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